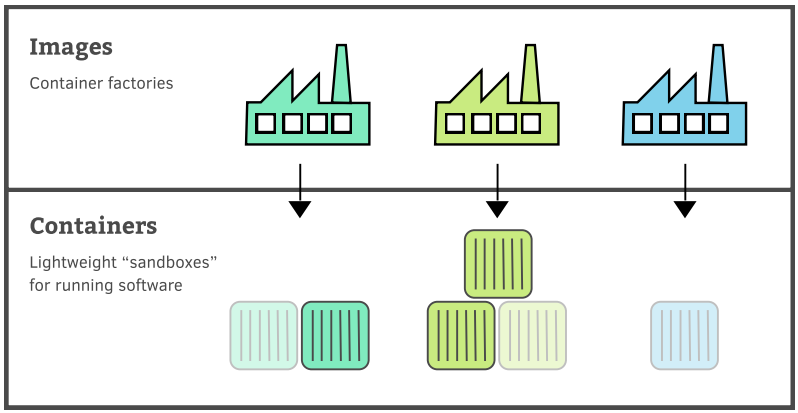
Using an image, you can spawn as many containers as you like that all look the same. For this reason, you may find it useful to think of an image as a *factory* for creating specific containers. People have also likened images to an abstract class in programming, and containers to instances of that class.



Images are ideal for sharing and distributing software: they use a standard format that is designed to be portable. Docker provides built-in tools for distributing images. By sharing images, you can collaborate on software development between your team and make your software available for deployment.

Running a Ruby Script Without Ruby Installed

We're about to perform some magic. Using Docker, we're going to run a Ruby application without needing Ruby installed on our system.

Have a look at this:

```
$ docker run ruby:2.6 ruby -e "puts :hello"
Unable to find image 'ruby:2.6' locally
2.6: Pulling from library/ruby
cd8eada9c7bb: Pull complete
c2677faec825: Pull complete
fcce419a96b1: Pull complete
045b51e26e75: Pull complete
3b969ad6f147: Pull complete
f2db762ad32e: Pull complete
708e57760f1b: Pull complete
06478b05a41b: Pull complete
Digest: sha256:ad724f6982b4a7c2d2a8a4ecb67267a1961a518029244ed943e2d448d6fb7
994
Status: Downloaded newer image for ruby:2.6
hello
```

Whoa. What just happened there?